Where 30 cities publish brand-new businesses

A business that opened last week needs a website, a Google profile, reviews and a way to book, and nobody's pitching it yet. Most big cities publish every new license or business registration as open data. Here's where to find them in 30 cities across the US and Canada, each one opened and checked on November 6, 2026.

How to use any of these in 3 steps

1. **Open the link and filter the date field** to the last 14–30 days. Always add "date is on or before today": several files have typo dates in the future. Sort newest first.
2. **Keep only the new ones.** Use the "Keep only" column below (for example Chicago's `APPLICATION TYPE` = ISSUE). "Pending" or "in progress" means they haven't opened yet: the best moment to show up with a preview.
3. **Pick the categories that fit what you sell** (restaurants, salons, contractors, shops), check each one on Google Maps (listed? website? reviews?) and put the best 5 in your lead tracker.

On most portals (Chicago, NYC, LA, SF, Seattle, Texas, Calgary, Edmonton…) the filter is under **Actions › Query data** or **Filter**, then **Export › CSV**. On map-style portals (DC, Denver, Sacramento, Miami-Dade, Fort Worth): **View data table**, filter, then **Download › CSV**.

Privacy, always: many files also list owner names and home-based businesses. Skip home-based and sole-owner rows, pitch the business at its business address or through its public phone or email, and never repost anyone's personal details. Before emailing, follow CAN-SPAM (US) or CASL (Canada).

US cities where every business registers

City	Open this	Filter on	Keep only	Updates
Chicago, IL	Business Licenses	`DATE ISSUED`	`APPLICATION TYPE` = ISSUE (new)	daily
Los Angeles, CA	Listing of Active Businesses	`LOCATION START DATE` (use 45 days)	by `PRIMARY NAICS DESCRIPTION`	monthly

San Francisco, CA	Registered Business Locations	`Location Start Date`	`Location End Date` blank	daily
Seattle, WA	Active Business License Tax Certificate	`License Start Date` (text, YYYYMMDD)	by `NAICS Description`	daily
Washington, DC	Basic Business License in Last 30 Days	`INITIALISSUEDATE`	skip Housing and Lodging	daily
Philadelphia, PA	L&I Business Licenses	`initialissuedate`	skip Rental and Vacant Residential	daily
New Orleans, LA	Occupational Business Licenses	`BusinessStartDate`	skip Special Events and Flea Market	daily
Orlando, FL	Business Tax Receipts	`Business Open Date`	active, by `License Category`	daily
Miami-Dade County, FL	Local Business Tax	`BUSSDATE` (use 60 days)	`NEWBUS` = Yes, `BUSCITY` = your city	~6 weeks behind
San Diego, CA	Business Tax Certificates	`date_account_creation`	"Active certificates" file	daily
Sacramento, CA	Business Operation Tax Information	`Business_Start_Date`	Active or Pending	daily
Long Beach, CA	Business Licenses (BizMap)	`ISSDTTM`	Issued, `HOMEBASED` = No (Intake = opening soon)	nightly
Tucson, AZ	Business License Downloads	the newest monthly file	already only new businesses	monthly
Las Vegas, NV	CLV Business Licenses	no date column: use `Status`	Pending (about to open) or Issued	irregular

Texas (no city business license, so use the state's sales-tax permits)

City	Open this	Filter on	Keep only	Updates
Houston, Dallas, Austin, San Antonio (any Texas city)	Active Sales Tax Permit Holders	`Outlet Permit Issue Date`	`Outlet City` = your city; NAICS 722 (restaurants), 812 (personal services)	monthly
Fort Worth	Certificates of Occupancy	`CODate`	`ApplicationType` = Occupancy	daily

US cities that publish part of the picture

City	Open this	What it covers	Keep only	Updates
New York City	Restaurant Inspection Results · Issued Licenses	new restaurants · licensed trades (contractors, electronics, garages…)	restaurants: `INSPECTION DATE` = 1900-01-01 (new, not yet inspected) · licenses: `Initial Issuance Date`, Premises	daily · weekly
Denver, CO	Pending Business Licenses	food, liquor and other licensed types	`LICENSE_TYPE` = Retail Food (about to open)	daily
Boston, MA	Active Food Establishment Licenses	food only	newest `license_add_dt_tm`	daily
Portland, OR	New Businesses Registered Last Month	every new Oregon registration	`City` = PORTLAND; check it's a storefront	monthly
Nashville, TN	Beer Permit Locations	restaurants, bars, markets	`Date_Entered` = applied recently	daily

Canada

City	Open this	Filter on	Keep only	Updates
Toronto, ON	Business Licences and Permits	`Issued`	`Cancel Date` blank; skip taxi and driving-school categories	daily
Vancouver, BC	Business licences	`IssuedDate`	`LicenceRevisionNumber` = 00 (new); late Nov–Jan is renewal season	daily
Calgary, AB	Calgary Business Licences	`FIRST_ISS_DT`	`HOMEOCCIND` = N (skip home-based)	daily
Edmonton, AB	Business Licences	`Original Issue Date`	by licence category	daily
Winnipeg, MB	Business Licenses	`Issue Date` (use 60 days)	Personal Services (salons, spas)	monthly
Montréal, QC	Établissements alimentaires	`date_statut`	`statut` = Ouvert or En traitement (opening soon)	weekly

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Your city isn't here?

- **State and provincial registries** (new LLCs and corporations; many are holding companies or home addresses, so check for a storefront or a Google listing first): Colorado (daily) ·

Connecticut (daily) · Florida Sunbiz daily filings · Oregon (monthly) · Texas permits (any Texas city) · Québec REQ (bulk file) · Ontario Business Registry (search only).

- **A nearby city often publishes:** for the Phoenix area, Scottsdale; in Orange County, Anaheim's new licences.
- **Other "just opened" signals:** Google Maps listings with only a few, very recent reviews, Yelp's "Hot and New", local news "grand opening" posts, and "coming soon" signs on storefronts.
- **Searched and found nothing public (Nov 2026), so don't waste an evening:** Phoenix, San Jose, Oakland, Minneapolis, St. Paul, Detroit, Columbus, Baltimore, Charlotte, Raleigh, Indianapolis, Jacksonville, Tampa, Ottawa. Kansas City and Atlanta publish old snapshots only.

Do it faster: the free `find-new-businesses` skill checks city license data, Google Maps, Yelp "Hot and New" and grand-opening news for you, then checks which ones have no website: github.com/WordRocket/local-client-finder. Or use prompt 6 in "20 Claude prompts to land local clients". Portals change their links and fields; if one moves, search the city's open-data site for "business license". Results vary.